



'WE HAVE PREPARED OURSELVES VERY WELL'

Dheeraj Gopichand Hinduja of Ashok Leyland talks about the company's future plans as he sees growth ahead

BY **ALOKESH BHATTACHARYYA**



PHOTO BY **RA CHANDROO**

DHEERAJ GOPICHAND HINDUJA, Executive Chairman of Ashok Leyland, is highly optimistic about the company's potential for growth in the coming years. Apart from strengthening its core heavy vehicles business, the 52-year-old has focussed on powering the company into the unfamiliar light vehicle territory, and has also crafted a multi-fuel plan to prepare for the future. Edited excerpts:



Sales were falling, not just for you, but commercial vehicles overall, even before the pandemic...

I guess 2018 was the peak for the industry. And the industry always goes in cycles. In 2012-13, there was a down cycle. And for four or five years [after that], we had very good growth momentum. There was an expectation that in April 2020, the new BS VI emission norms would come. So everyone felt that this momentum would continue till March 31, 2020. But the industry started slowing down earlier, much to our surprise. We were all hoping it would take another year, but actually, it took steam a little earlier and then started declining gradually. And then with Covid-19, it really hit all of us badly.



Do you think the industry is now at the beginning of the next upcycle?

Very much. Since September 2021, we've been seeing month-on-month growth in the industry. The total industry volume is almost at the peak